

EVANGELIZE

Resources for those who don't know Jesus yet or have not made Him Lord of their life

navigators™

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THE THREE CIRCLES

Have you ever had anyone share the Gospel with you? Follow along below in the Three Circles illustration to make sense of and find healing from the brokenness we all experience.

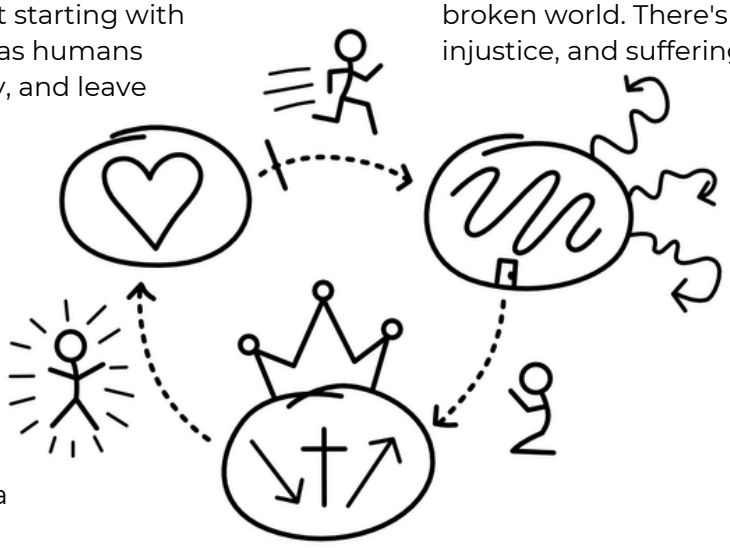
Scan the QR code to watch a video on how to share the Three Circles Illustration:

Perfect Creation 2

The world was perfect when God created it. There was no death, disease, injustice or suffering. But starting with the very first people, we as humans chose to go our own way, and leave God's perfect design. That's called sin. And sin led to the world's brokenness.

Broken World 1

If you turn on the television or look at your social media feed, it's very clear we live in a broken world. There's a lot of death, disease, injustice, and suffering.



Failed Escape 3

It is not pleasant to live in a broken world, so we try to get out. Some through climbing the ladder of success, others by doing good things, being religious or going to church. Some by drowning out the brokenness with drugs or a relationship. But like bungee cords, they keep snapping us back into our broken world.

Whole Redemption 4

But God loved us so much that He provided a way out of this broken-ness through His Son, Jesus. Jesus came down into our world, allowing Himself to be killed on a cross, taking on our sin. Three days later He rose from the dead, and declared that if anyone would turn from their ways, surrender to Him, and believe He died and rose again, they would be forgiven. They would also be made new and be able to experience God's perfect design for their life.

Questions 5

Where are you? Are you still in brokenness or have you placed your faith in Jesus, trusting Him for His perfect design for your life? What is keeping you from trusting Jesus as Lord?

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WHO SITS ON THE THRONE?

Galatians 2:20 says *"For I have been crucified with Christ. It is no longer I who live but Christ in me. And the life I now live in the flesh, I live by faith in the son of God who loved me and gave himself for me."*

What are some observations about this verse?
Most would say "being crucified" is not good news. How do you think this would be good news?
Or to put it another way: If you were the master of your own island, how would it be good news to be conquered?

Consider three scenarios: (Write in the aspects of someone's life for each circle, i.e. academics, finances, relationships, etc. They should look the same in each scenario.)
(1) Self on the throne [Non-Christian]
How does it feel if one rules their own life? Consider who this person turns to when they need help, how they protect themselves, and concerns they might have.

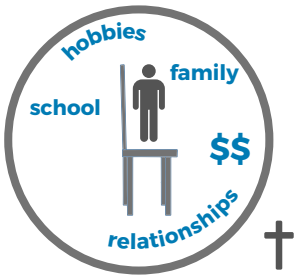
(2) Self on the throne; Jesus assisting with life [Cultural Christian]
What does it feel like to have Jesus assisting in someone's life? What would be indicators of a life like this? What would it take to "lose" favor in this situation? What feelings would come from this type of situation? Would it look any different than the first situation?

(3) Jesus sits on the throne; self inside of life [Contagious Christian]
What does it feel like to have someone who is good and powerful be in charge of someone's life? What is appealing about this? What is challenging?

How would it feel to have someone conquer your private island if they would rule the island better than you?

Non-Christian

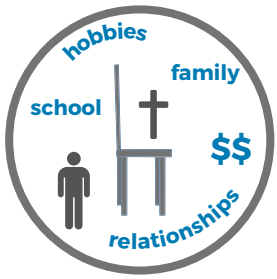
Self-Directed Life



Self is on the throne.
Christ is outside the life.
Interests are directed by self, often resulting in **anxiety and frustration.**

Contagious Christian

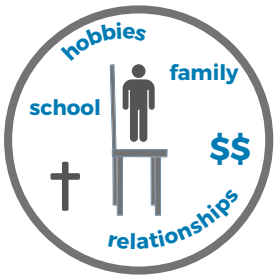
Christ-Directed Life



Life is Christ-centered
Self has been dethroned
Interests are still present but point back to Christ, leading to **hope, joy and peace**.

Cultural Christian

Self-Directed Life

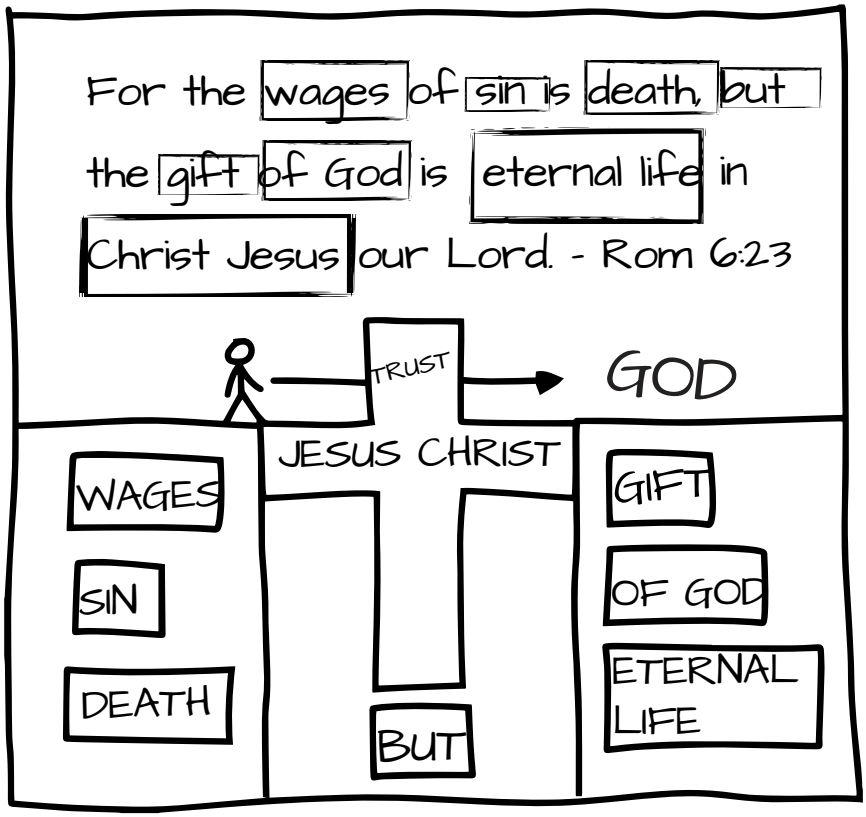


Self is on the throne.
Christ is dethroned.
Interests reveal a loss of love for God, His plans, and His ways; anxiety remains yet **legalism** reigns.

Questions to Consider:

Which picture most accurately displays your life? Why do you think that?
Which picture displays what you desire your life to look like? Why?
What action will you take to move towards the picture you desire?

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The One Verse Bridge is a simple, interactive way to share Christ's love conversationally and visually. As you are in a conversation with a friend, you can illustrate Romans 6:23 on a napkin or piece of paper to explain God's relationship with people.

ONE VERSE BRIDGE

Circle WAGES and ask, "How would you feel if your boss refused to pay you the wages that were due to you?" Of course, your friend would want justice, the wages he had worked for. Deep down, we all know that it is only right that we get what we deserve.

Draw a circle around SIN, asking your friend what he thinks when he hears this word. You might explain that sin is more an attitude than an action. It can be either actively fighting God or as simple as excluding Him from our lives. Now draw two opposing cliffs with a gap in between.

Circle DEATH and ask what thoughts come to mind. Explain that death in the Bible always means some kind of separation—in its most basic sense, separation from life. Because God is the author of life, a spiritual death simply means separation from Him.

While circling the word BUT mention that it is important because it means that a sharp contrast in ideas is coming. What we have just looked at is the bad news; what comes next is the good news.

Draw a circle around GIFT. Ask, "If wages are what a person earns, then what is a gift?" Though every gift is free for the person receiving it, someone still has to purchase it.

Circle OF GOD and explain that the gift you are talking about is free. It is from God Himself. It's so special that no one else can give it. Ask, "How do you feel when someone gives you a special gift?"

Circle ETERNAL LIFE next, and then ask, "How would you define these words?" Contrast one side of the cliff, death, with the other side, eternal life. Ask, "What is the opposite of separation from God?"

Write JESUS CHRIST so it creates a bridge between the two cliffs. Help your friend to consider that just as every gift has a unique giver, only Jesus Christ can give the gift of eternal life.

Write TRUST over the bridge. Explain that a true friend is a friend you can trust; Jesus is offering to be a true friend to him. All he has to do is admit that he is responsible for his sin— either of fighting against God or excluding Him from his life. Trusting Jesus means believing that He has power to forgive us for rejecting God and that He will wash us clean from all that we have done wrong in life.

Now, ask your friend if he wants to start a relationship with God that will last forever. If he says "Yes," invite him to pray a short prayer in his own words, asking Jesus to forgive him and make him new. Close by reminding him that this simple illustration shows what God is like: Someone who really cares about people—especially him. Invite him to read all about it in the Bible.

THIS TOOL IS MEANT TO BE SHARED. **To download a copy visit navlink.org/one-verse-evangelism**
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HOW MIGHT HOPE COME FROM KNOWING JESUS?

GOSPEL APPOINTMENT

"I AM THE MASTER OF MY FATE, I AND THE CAPTAIN OF MY SOUL."

That is what Henley said in his famous poem *Invictus*.
QUESTION: What do you think of that line? Do you agree or disagree?

If we are the captains of our own souls, we have a lot to carry. One person considered what her life would look like without a relationship with God. She thought writing the opposite meaning of a chapter from the Bible described it well. Read her descriptive poem together, underline or make marks on significant words or phrases, then discuss the questions below.

I lead my own life. There's a lot that I want.

I'm looking for a place to lie in rest, but I can't find it. There's a lot that I worry about, swirling waters all around.

My soul is fragmented. I'm left wandering, not knowing where to go, not knowing right from wrong, living for myself yet going nowhere.

I walk by death all day long, there's a lot that I fear. I feel alone. The comforts I chase after are good only for a short while, then I'm empty inside again.

In the presence of my enemies, I'm put to shame. I feel no blessing, I feel empty inside.

I don't know where good is. I don't know what my final resting place will be. I hope I find it one day.

QUESTION: Which of these statements do you most identify with? What would life look like if that wasn't the case?

Next, do the same thing you did with the above poem with the real one, Psalm 23, on the next page, then discuss the questions below.

HOW MIGHT HOPE COME FROM KNOWING JESUS?

Psalm 23

The LORD is my shepherd, I lack nothing.

He makes me lie down in green pastures, he leads me beside quiet waters, he refreshes my soul.

He guides me along the right paths for his name's sake.

Even though I walk through the darkest valley, I will fear no evil, for you are with me; your rod and your staff, they comfort me.

You prepare a table before me in the presence of my enemies. You anoint my head with oil; my cup overflows.

Surely your goodness and love will follow me all the days of my life, and I will dwell in the house of the LORD forever.

QUESTION: Since the LORD is another word for the name of Jesus, how might experiencing Jesus as your shepherd be better than you being the captain of your soul?

In another passage of the Bible, John 10:10-11, Jesus says:

"The (devil) comes only to steal and kill and destroy (the sheep); I have come that they may have life, and have it to the full. I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep."

QUESTION: Do you feel like you have the life that is being stolen, killed and destroyed; or the abundant life as described in Psalm 23? (Consider going back to compare and contrast Psalm 23 and the first version.)

NEXT STEPS:

- What takeaway do you have from thinking about and discussing the passages?
- Have you drawn any new conclusions about your life or who Jesus could be to you?
- For more information on how to receive forgiveness for your sins and receiving Jesus as your "good shepherd" as Lord and Savior - go over the "The Bridge to Life" illustration.

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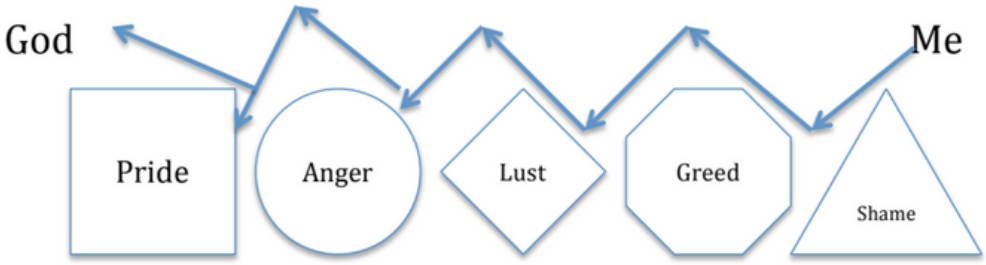


Gospel vs. Religion

What things about you do you wish God just didn't know or didn't see? These are often things that separate us from God. The shapes below represent these things.

Religion

When religion sees these things it tries to fix them through self-effort. Religion sees these issues as obstacles to be overcome. The religious person says, "I have to be better" and so they try to fix them through "being better" as seen in the arrows.



What does this result in?

1. Depression – Sure we'll make some progress in some areas but ultimately we will be overwhelmed by the progress that we cannot make. This results in depression as we throw up our hands in despair and quit since we cannot "make the grade".

2. Pride – For some of us we will make strides in some areas yet we will become frustrated with those who do not or choose not to make the same progress. This results in pride as we will see ourselves as better than these people. Think of the Pharisees in the time of Jesus and how they viewed others.

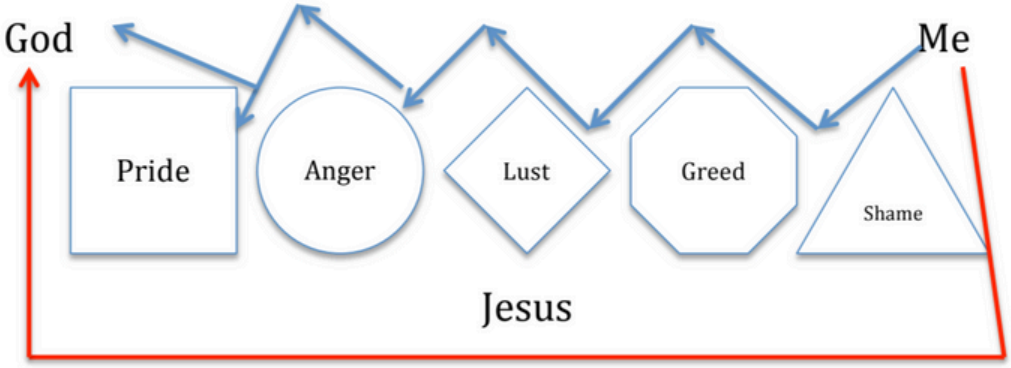
3. Unforgiveness – Similar to pride, there will be a lack of forgiveness on our part for those who choose not to grow. Why? Because we overcame it, they didn't, and we are tired of their excuses.

4. Duty – Our desire to change is driven by a duty to please God. We do it because we have to as we seek to earn his love or favor.

The Gospel or "Good News"

On the other hand the Gospel has nothing to do with you earning it. As the red line demonstrates (next page), Christ sees all of our mess, our shame, and our guilt yet He picks us up and places us right next to God. How? What about our shame, our sin? Well when God sees us now, He no longer sees our sin and shame, instead all He sees is Jesus' perfection. How? Because we choose to believe that Jesus died upon the cross for our sin/shame and rose from the dead on the third day. His perfection covers our imperfection. Ephesians 2:4-10 (next page) illustrates this as Paul tells us that God was rich in mercy so he covered our transgressions in Christ so that we may now be alive and seated next to Him in the heavenly realm. How do we receive this acceptance, this perfection? By faith in Jesus' sacrifice. He did it, we did nothing, and so we now gain everything. As verses eight and nine make clear, none of our full acceptance comes by works, it is all by faith in Christ so that none of us can boast of what we have done. In other words, there is no religion, no earning it.

Gospel vs. Religion



Ephesian 2:4-10 (NLT)

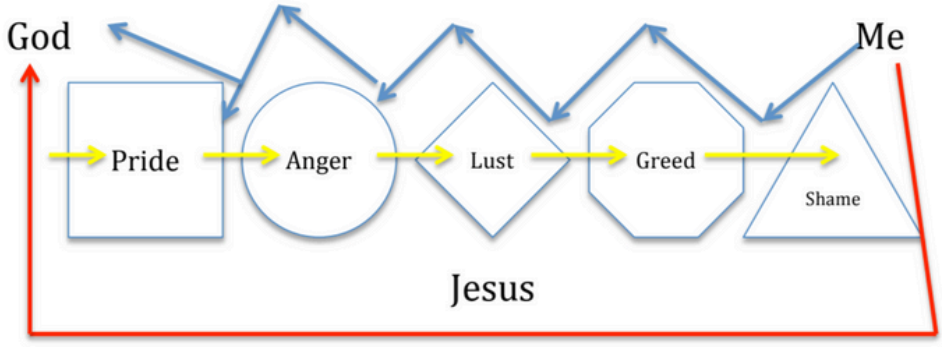
4 But God is so rich in mercy, and he loved us so much, 5 that even though we were dead because of our sins, he gave us life when he raised Christ from the dead. (It is only by God's grace that you have been saved!) 6 For he raised us from the dead along with Christ and seated us with him in the heavenly realms because we are united with Christ Jesus. 7 So God can point to us in all future ages as examples of the incredible wealth of his grace and kindness toward us, as shown in all he has done for us who are united with Christ Jesus.

8 God saved you by his grace when you believed. And you can't take credit for this; it is a gift from God. 9 Salvation is not a reward for the good things we have done, so none of us can boast about it. 10 For we are God's masterpiece. He has created us anew in Christ Jesus, so we can do the good things he planned for us long ago

What does this result in?
1. Joy – Instead of being weighed down in despair by all we have to do to earn acceptance, we now have joy because we are fully accepted and fully loved.
2. Humility – Humility is "passion for God" whereas pride is "passion for self". Since Jesus paid it all and made me whole, I now have passion for him. I want to champion Him and not myself since He fully loves and accepts me.
3. Forgiveness – Since Jesus has fully forgiven me I am called to forgive others. If in his perfection He can forgive all my mess, then how can I in my imperfection not forgive another imperfect person?
4. Love – The opposite of duty. I don't seek to follow God and be like him because I have to, I do it because I want to. If you love your spouse you don't have to put reminders around the house to tell you to be affectionate, tell them you love them, or serve them. You just do it. Why? Because you love them.

Yet things do not stop there....

Now that we are fully accepted by God He is not content to leave us alone. He knows all our sin and shame, He knows our mess, yet He wants to transform it. He desires to make us into who He created us to be. As a result God will chisel away at those shameful parts for the rest of your life as represented by the yellow line. As Ephesians 2:10 states, "We are His workmanship, created to do good works in Christ Jesus". We are fully accepted and at the same time a work in progress as the Holy Spirit is transforming us into God's "workmanship". We are like a messy house on "Hoarders", God owns the property no matter what and He wants to clean us out. It will take a while and there is no way the job will be completed on this side of eternity, but nonetheless He is at work. Then when we are in His presence we will finally be what God intended: fully loved, fully accepted, and our "house" clean and beautiful.



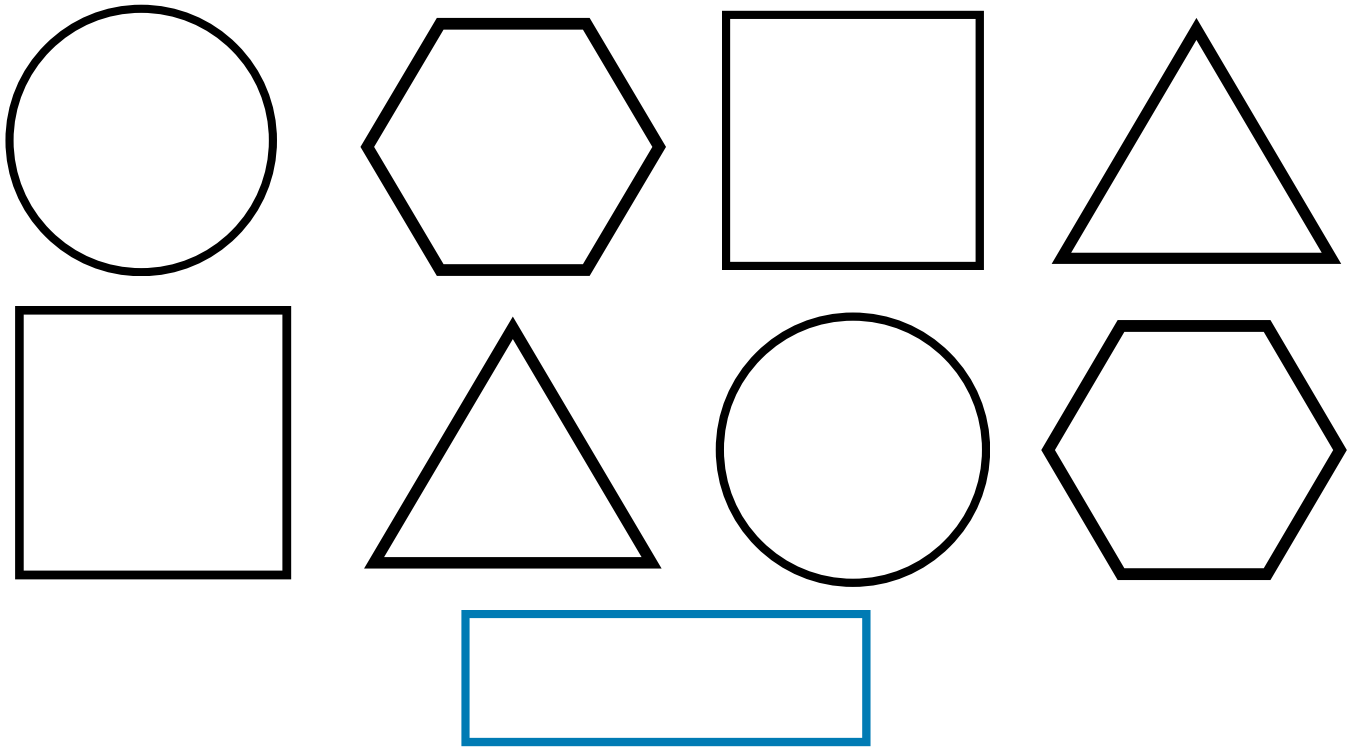
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THE WELL ILLUSTRATION

"People follow, give themselves to, trust in whatever they believe will give them life." This illustration shows what the Bible has to say about our pursuit for life.

1. Where do you find life (i.e. satisfaction, security, love, significance, ...)? Write your answers in the different black shapes ("wells") below.
2. Read the verse below and define the following words / phrases: *forsaken*, *dug*, *cisterns*, *broken*, and *spring of living water*.
   What does Jesus have to say about our search for life? *See John 4:13-14*
3. Now looking back over the shapes ("wells"), answer the following questions:
   a. Why do you try to meet your needs in this "well"?
   b. When you have gone to this "well", what have you experienced or learned? Draw cracks in each of the shapes to signify that these will always fail us.
   c. What prevents you from going to Christ, the Spring of Living Water? Write Jesus in the bottom blue shape, with water spreading to all the other “wells”.



My people have committed two sins: They have forsaken me, the spring of living water, and have dug their own cisterns, broken cisterns that cannot hold water.
Jeremiah 2:13

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FIVE ASSURANCES OF FAITH

1 John 3:19-20 [NIV]
"This is how we know that we belong to the truth and how we set our hearts at rest in his presence: If our hearts condemn us, **we know that God is greater than our hearts**, and he knows everything."

The Bible is full of key promises and assurances about who God is, who we are and our relationship with Him. Below are five key Biblical assurances for all Christians. If you have a relationship with Jesus these assurances are true of you no matter what you feel, what you've done (positive or negative) or what others have done to you. The fact of what God says of us is what we place our faith in, which in turn determines our feelings. Spend time reading through the verses below and reflect together on the following questions. How does faith in each of the assurances provide an anchor of comfort to you?

1 **Assurance of Salvation** *1 John 5:11-13*
Who are the two types of people in this passage? What makes them different? Where does life come from? How do we get it?

2 **Assurance of Answered Prayer** *John 16:24*
What do we need to do in order to "receive" an answer to our prayers? What is the difference between asking in someone else's name and Jesus' name? How are different ways that God could answer? Does answering mean I receive whatever I ask for?

3 **Assurance of Victory** *1 Corinthians 10:13*
Is your temptation unique to just you? How does God help us in the midst of temptation? Do you believe that God can empower you to overcome any sin? How is that seen in how you think & live?

4 **Assurance of Forgiveness** *1 John 1:9*
What are we called to do in this verse? What does God say in response? Are there limitations to what, when or how often He will forgive?

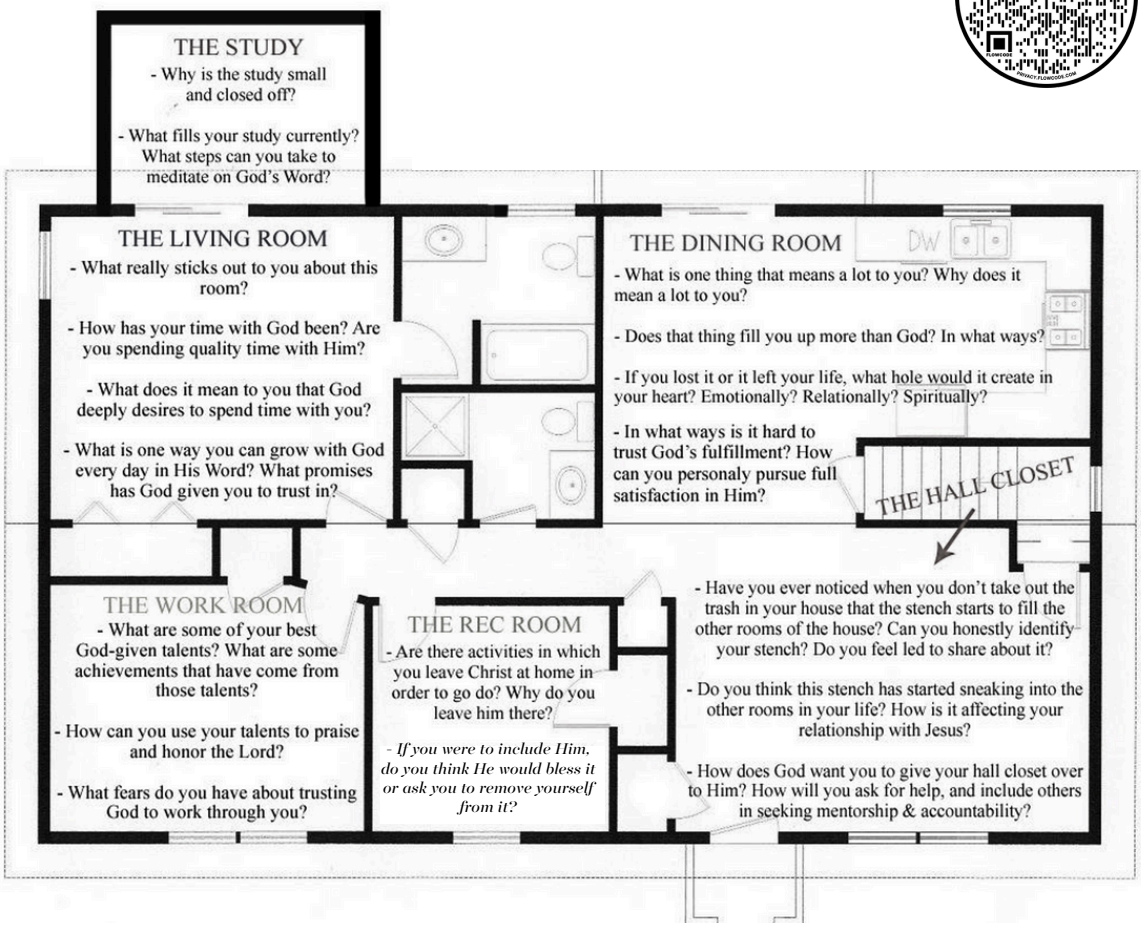
5 **Assurance of Guidance** *Proverbs 3:5-6*
What his God's role in this verse? What are we told to do/not do? Can we withhold any part of life from God? Why or why not?

THIS TOOL IS MEANT TO BE SHARED. Adapted from the Growing with Christ series.

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MY HEART, CHRIST'S HOME

Inviting Jesus into our lives can be compared to inviting Him to live in our home. Jesus does not simply want to be a guest, but to own the home and shape us into the man or woman He perfectly designed us to be. Spend time either together or own your own reading through the short story My Heart, Christ's Home by Robert Munger (scan the QR code), then pick a room below to discuss.



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